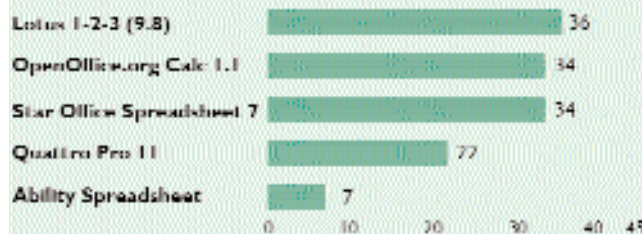


Spreadsheet scores



rest were completely unusable. While it supported multiple worksheets in a single spreadsheet and understood the formulas without any errors, the graphs in the worksheets did not turn up. It also had minor formatting problems, but displayed

the vertically merged cells perfectly. **Lotus 1-2-3** Formatically challenged

Lotus 1-2-3 has an amazing level of compatibility with Excel files. In the main sheet, all the data, formulas and graphs across multiple worksheets were properly imported. However, the formulas were written in a completely different format. When there were problems with importing, it created and displayed a detailed log file. There were minor formatting errors, though—it didn't display vertically merged cells properly.

PRESENTATION SOFTWARE

StarOffice Presentation

A star indeed!

StarOffice Presentation was the best tool as compared to the other presentation software. In PowerPoint slides, StarOffice 7 gave better performance than the other software, but had problems displaying some of the custom bullets.

OpenOffice.org Impress

It did impress

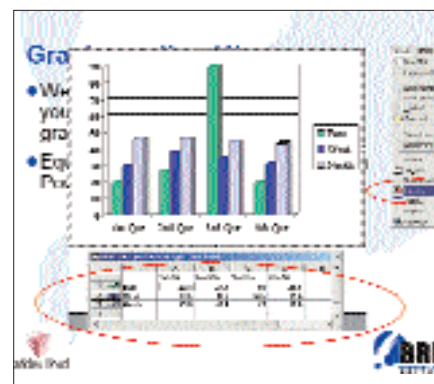
This product was very similar to the StarOffice Presentation tool, and gave similar results. Overall, however, StarOffice is a better product since it came with its own java libraries whereas OpenOffice.org didn't have one. When it came to custom bullets, OpenOffice.org completely ignored them whereas StarOffice

replaced them with simple ones.

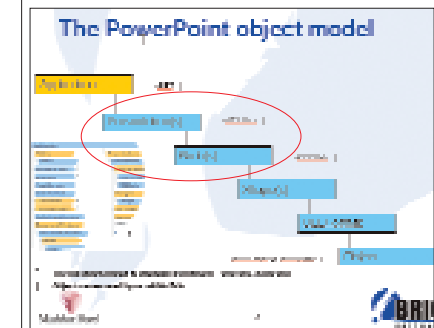
WordPerfect Presentations11

Far from being perfect

Presentations 11 had problems with the



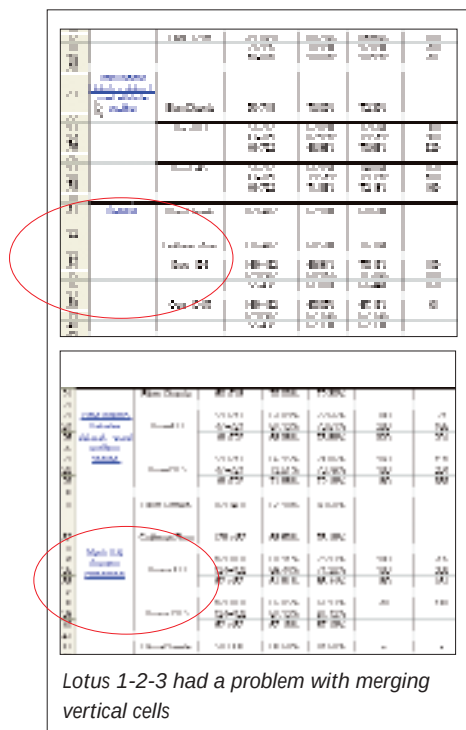
Corel Presentations 11 had a problem displaying background images. At places, it displayed the background image over the foreground text



Some of the slides could not be reproduced perfectly by Presentations



Lotus Freelance Screenshow had no problems displaying complex slides, such as the one here



Lotus 1-2-3 had a problem with merging vertical cells

AppleWorks 6

Although it's good at handling its own file formats, and offers excellent rendering of text, images and tables, AppleWorks has problems in the MS Office compatibility department. In our word document tests, AppleWorks wasn't able to display simple colours within the tables in one of the test files; it showed grey shades in place of the actual green and red. Moreover, it couldn't handle the table layout properly. It had problems in the standard text formatting test file too; white text on a black background was not displayed. As far as presentations are

concerned, AppleWorks can't handle PowerPoint files, so there's no question of compatibility.

In Excel, Apple Works couldn't handle more than one worksheet. The formulas that used multiple worksheets got altered when opened in AppleWorks, and the parts of the formulas that referred to other worksheets were removed. The graphs that were linked to the main worksheet, but displayed in other worksheets also weren't displayed. In sum, Apple Works simply is not a product meant for MS Office compatibility.